



The uprising begins

A Russian chess playing robot broke the finger of a 7 year old boy who reportedly didn't wait his turn.
<https://digit.in/aug22-09>



Sony WF-1000XM4 features capacitive touch controls on the rear panel of the earbuds while the AirPods Pro features pressure-sensitive controls on the stem. We found the AirPods Pro controls to be slightly more precise. However, Sony's touch controls are far improved in comparison to their predecessor and work without almost any hitches or misreadings.

Build and design winner - Tie

COMFORT AND FIT

While which pair of earphones has the better design is up for debate, the AirPods Pro are unequivocally superior when it comes to comfort and fit. Now, the Sonys do redeem themselves a bit here due to the bundled foam ear tips. The polyurethane foam ear tips are available in three sizes - small, medium, and large. You simply need to compress the foam tips before inserting them into your ears and the tips will expand to fit the contours of your ear canal.

While the foam tips do provide a far more superior fit than silicone ones would have on the Sony WF-1000XM4, there's still no denying its bulky form factor that does hamper comfort, especially after long periods of usage. The AirPods Pro provide silicone ear tips, but the fit is still far more secure since the earbuds are lighter and sleeker. The AirPods just latch on to your ear and feel secure through moderate and intensive activities such as walking, jogging, and working out. Additionally, Sony's bulky earbuds also start hurting your ears after longer

listening sessions while the discomfort is minimal on the AirPods Pro for the same duration.

Credit where it's due though - Sony has considerably shrunk down the size of the WF-1000XM4 in comparison to its predecessor, the WF-1000XM3. The case is 40 per cent smaller while the earbuds are 10 per cent smaller, which is no small feat. However, we're hoping that with the Mark 5s, Sony continues to shrink down the size of the earphones, especially the earbuds, to provide a more secure and comfortable fit. For now, though, the AirPods Pro definitely knock it out of the park for comfort and fit.

Comfort and fit winner - AirPods Pro

SOUND QUALITY

Coming to the most important question of all - how do the Sony WF-1000XM4 and the AirPods Pro compare in the sound quality department? To understand this, let's go into the hardware these earbuds sport. The Sony WF-1000XM4 pack 6mm drivers with support for SBC, AAC and

LDAC codecs. With LDAC, you can listen to hi-res music up to 32-bit/96 kHz over Bluetooth at up to 990 kbps. The earphones are powered by Sony's V1 chip which helps with Sony's DSEE feature that upscales music to near-lossless quality.

Powering the AirPods Pro is Apple's H1 chip that is also built into the second and third-gen AirPods. Apple also brings in spatial audio technology with head tracking. The earphones support SBC and AAC codecs with AAC providing stable and reliable audio when the earphones are used with iPhones. If you were to use the Sony Mark 4s with an iPhone, the codec would default to AAC since Apple doesn't support codecs such as LDAC and aptX.

Now, both earphones are sonically brilliant with Sony adding some more meat to the bass department. The bass response is slightly more pronounced on the AirPods Pro but the Sony WF-1000XM4's bass packs much more detail and character with excellent attack. The AirPods lack some of the clarity provided by the Sony earphones with LDAC active.

The mids are pristine on both earphones with close-to-neutral sonic signatures. As a result, vocals and lead instruments have almost unmatched clarity (in the TWS space). However, the Sony has a slightly wider soundstage which adds a layer of finesse to the audio. The imaging is also slightly better on the Sony WF-1000XM4 when compared to the AirPods Pro. But if you listen to tracks with spatial audio support on the AirPods, the tides

